

Ideation Phase

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Date	01 October 2026
Team ID	SWTID-2026-9577
Project Name	Import Data using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Step-1: Team Gathering, Collaboration and Select the Problem Statement

1 Team Gathering

Team: 4 members gathered for the Import Data using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet) project. User: ServiceNow administrator / data analyst who imports spreadsheet data into ServiceNow tables.

Goal: import spreadsheet (Excel/CSV) records into ServiceNow tables quickly, accurately and with less manual data entry.

2 Collaborate

Before collaborating: each member reviews the empathy map, PS-1 and PS-2, and checks the sample spreadsheet columns, data quality, required fields and the target table.

Key activities: create a Data Source, load the spreadsheet into an Import Set, create the Transform Map and field maps, set coalesce, run the transform and verify the records.

3 Define Problem Statement

Problem Statement

How might we import spreadsheet data into ServiceNow quickly and accurately using transform maps, without duplicate or incorrect records?

Brainstorming rules

Stay on topic, encourage wild ideas, defer judgment, listen to others, build on others' ideas, go for volume and focus on solving the import problem.

Step-2: Brainstorm, Idea Listing and Grouping

2

Brainstorm

Write down any ideas that come to mind that address your problem statement.

🕒 10 minutes

TIP

You can select a sticky note and hit the pencil [switch to sketch] icon to start drawing!

Person 1			Person 2			Person 3			Person 4		
Remove blank rows	Pre-import quality check	Reusable transform maps	Standard date format	Use a standard template sheet	Auto-map matching columns	Check required fields	Field map preview	Transform scripts for rules	Validate data types	Save mapping templates	Match on unique ID
Update existing records	Highlight failed rows	Import small sample	Default values for blanks	Duplicate check report	Retry failed records	Set coalesce on key field	Skip identical rows	Download error report	Merge old duplicates	Clear import error log	Test in sub-prod first

3

Group ideas

Take turns sharing your ideas while clustering similar or related notes as you go. In the last 10 minutes, give each cluster a sentence-like label. If a cluster is bigger than six sticky notes, try and see if you can break it up into smaller sub-groups.

🕒 20 minutes

TIP

Add customizable tags to sticky notes to make it easier to find, browse, organize, and categorize important ideas as themes within your mural.

Clean, validate and standardize spreadsheet data before import		Auto-suggest and reuse field mappings in transform maps		Use coalesce to update instead of duplicating records		Make import errors easy to find and fix, and test safely	
Remove blank rows	Standard date format	Auto-map matching columns	Field map preview	Set coalesce on key field	Match on unique ID	Clear import error log	Highlight failed rows
Check required fields	Validate data types	Save mapping templates	Reusable transform maps	Update existing records	Duplicate check report	Retry failed records	Download error report
Pre-import quality check	Use a standard template sheet	Default values for blanks	Transform scripts for rules	Skip identical rows	Merge old duplicates	Test in sub-prod first	Import small sample

Step-3: Idea Prioritization

4

Prioritize

Your team should all be on the same page about what's important moving forward. Place your ideas on this grid to determine which ideas are important and which are feasible.

🕒 20 minutes

